

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.031**

SUBJECT: Dysphagia Screening,
Management, and Treatment

POINT PERSON: Chief of Medicine

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD  **DATE: JULY 25, 2024**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☐ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☒ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. Oregon State Hospital (OSH) follows established guidelines for routine screening of the signs and symptoms of dysphagia in order to identify patients who have a pre-existing condition or develop signs and symptoms related to dysphagia. This policy outlines the requirements for dysphagia screening, management, and treatment at OSH.
- B. This policy applies to clinical staff.

II. POLICY

- A. Physicians and nurse practitioners are ultimately responsible for oversight of dysphagia screening, management, and care.
- B. All patients newly admitted to OSH must be screened for the risk of dysphagia.
- C. Risk of dysphagia must be assessed in all patients as part of the initial and annual medical history and physical examination.
- D. Any patient with a significant choking incident requiring assistance from staff must be assessed by a physician or nurse practitioner for a formal swallowing evaluation by a speech-language pathologist.
- E. Physicians, nurse practitioners, nurses, dietitians, and other clinicians must follow procedures attached to this policy when managing dysphagia risk.
- F. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation

standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.

- G. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. “Clinical staff” means any person employed or contracted by OSH to provide clinical services to patients.
- B. “Staff” includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH).

IV. PROCEDURES

Procedures A Dysphagia Screening Procedures

V. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

VI. REFERENCES

- Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2024). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for behavioral healthcare and human services*, CTS.04.03.33.Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.
- Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2024). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*, PC.02.02.03.Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.